



An Introduction to Audience Teaching Ideas

Learning Objective:

To explore the concept of audience.

Success Criteria:

- To understand what is meant by audience.
- To consider different audience responses.
- To practise writing for a specific audience.

Context

One of a series of An Introduction to... lessons, exploring language and literature concepts that are fundamental to academic success at KS3/4.

Starter

Key Questions

Discussion-based exploration of concept as means of establishing ideas and prior knowledge. Pupils can be told in advance that audience is a complex concept without straightforward answers (beyond the basic dictionary definition of an audience as the consumers of texts), which should become increasingly apparent as the lesson progresses. To illustrate the point further and to help disseminate thinking, operate a group carousel so that the audience for a pupil's viewpoint is constantly shifting. At the end of the activity, put the following questions to the class: 1. Did responses change according to the group they were discussed with? 2. Does this tell us anything about audience?

Main Activities

Making it APT

Consideration of audience in relation to purpose and tone. The [Identifying Audiences Worksheet](#) tests the ability to discern the likely audience but the crux of the activity is replicated on the [PowerPoint](#) slide to keep the lesson print-free if desired.

Audience Theory

Taking fairy tales as examples, pupils to consider the messages encoded into texts. With reference to Stuart Hall's audience positioning theory, they should then consider alternative readings that different audiences might have of a text. For example, the preferred or dominant reading (in as far as this can be known) of **Little Red Riding Hood** could be that children should obey their parents and that girls are vulnerable, requiring the protection of men. An oppositional feminist reading is that men are wolves, preying on vulnerable females.

Considering Context

A consideration of primary and secondary audiences with relevance to English Literature AO3.

The Reader in the Writer

The theory presented here basically amounts to good readers equal good writers and vice versa because of an understanding of audience. As more experienced readers, have pupils write instructions for primary school starters on how to tell a story. This task demands that they think carefully about the audience and making their writing apt. You could also take the opportunity to discuss possible differences between audiences of fiction and non-fiction texts, e.g. letters tend to be individualised, speeches are delivered direct to a live audience and the only audience for a diary entry tends to be yourself.

Plenary

Summary of learning in the form of an exit pass – an [Exit Pass](#) template is included but this could just as easily be completed in books or on spare paper.